THE MARATHAS, SHIVAJI AND AURANGZEB'S DECCAN; THE JAGIRDARI CRISIS

DECCAN SERVICE FIELD AND → SHIVAJI'S STATE FORMATION: JAVLI → PURANDAR, AGRA AND THE → ADMINISTRATION AND REVENUE: ASHTAPRADHAN → MILITARY ORGANISATION, NAVAL POWER → SUCCESSORS: SAMBHAJI, RAJARAM, GINGEE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA

STAGE 00

DECCAN SERVICE FIELD AND SHAHJI BHONSLE

DECCAN SERVICE FIELD AND SHAHJI BHONSLE · THE COLLAPSING NIZAM SHAHI ORDER AT AHMADNAGAR PUSHED DECCAN · SHAHJI BHONSLE'S CAREER SHOWS MOBILE SERVICE POLITICS ACROSS THIS · THIS CAREER IS NOT EVIDENCE OF A HEREDITARY ANTI-MUGHAL

The collapsing Nizam Shahi order at Ahmadnagar pushed Deccan military households into a wider Bijapur

Shahji Bhonsle's career shows mobile service politics across this world, including support for a Nizam → This career is not evidence of a hereditary anti-Mughal crusade and not proto-nationalism handed down → Jija Bai gave the Poona household local legitimacy and authority, and this role must be

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- The collapsing Nizam Shahi order at Ahmadnagar pushed Deccan military households into a wider Bijapur, Mughal and Golconda-adjacent service world.
- Shahji Bhonsle's career shows mobile service politics across this world, including support for a Nizam Shahi claimant, which

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- This career is not evidence of a hereditary anti-Mughal crusade and not proto-nationalism handed down to Shivaji.
- Jija Bai gave the Poona household local legitimacy and authority, and this role must be stated in bounded

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Dadoji Konddev is a secure administrative actor in the early Poona setting, not the single architect of Maratha statecraft.
- The verdict is that Deccan service politics, not a nationalist inheritance, explains the household's early rise.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The collapsing Nizam Shahi order at Ahmadnagar pushed Deccan military households into a wider Bijapur, Mughal and Golconda-adjacent service world. Shahji Bhonsle's career shows mobile service politics across this world, including support for a Nizam Shahi claimant, which in turn secured the Poona jagir and household for his family. This career is not evidence of a hereditary anti-Mughal crusade and not proto-nationalism handed down to Shivaji. Jija Bai gave the Poona household local legitimacy and authority, and this role must be stated in bounded terms rather than inflated into sole authorship of the later Maratha state. Dadoji Konddev is a secure administrative actor in the early Poona setting, not the single architect of Maratha statecraft. The verdict is that Deccan service politics, not a nationalist inheritance, explains the household's early rise.

STAGE 01

SHIVAJI'S STATE FORMATION: JAVLI AND THE FORTS

SHIVAJI'S STATE FORMATION · JAVLI AND THE FORTS · JAVLI IN 1656 REMOVED THE MORE FAMILY'S POSITION AND · THE FIRST FORTS, BUILT AND SEIZED BETWEEN 1645 AND

Javli in 1656 removed the More family's position and opened Maval-Satara-Konkan routes, converting a jagir → The first forts, built and seized between 1645 and 1647, gave an expanding fort-anchored base → Afzal Khan's death at Pratapgad in 1659 is secure at its core -- mutual suspicion → The qualification means that geography enabled this repertoire, while political organisation and calculated coercion made

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- Javli in 1656 removed the More family's position and opened Maval-Satara-Konkan routes, converting a jagir and local relations
- The first forts, built and seized between 1645 and 1647, gave an expanding fort-anchored base for further consolidation.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Afzal Khan's death at Pratapgad in 1659 is secure at its core -- mutual suspicion, his death and
- The qualification means that geography enabled this repertoire, while political organisation and calculated coercion made territorial consolidation durable,

IMPACT / LIMIT

- Javli in 1656 removed the More family's position and opened Maval-Satara-Konkan routes, converting a jagir and local relations
- The first forts, built and seized between 1645 and 1647, gave an expanding fort-anchored base for further consolidation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Javli in 1656 removed the More family's position and opened Maval-Satara-Konkan routes, converting a jagir and local relations into territorial capacity rather than abolishing every hereditary right in the region. The first forts, built and seized between 1645 and 1647, gave an expanding fort-anchored base for further consolidation. Afzal Khan's death at Pratapgad in 1659 is secure at its core -- mutual suspicion, his death and Maratha territorial gains are not in dispute -- but the exact first-blow sequence depends on the bakhar genre and is not primary-source certainty. The qualification means that geography enabled this repertoire, while political organisation and calculated coercion made territorial consolidation durable, and this sequencing is the correct answer-frame for state formation.

STAGE 02

PURANDAR, AGRA AND THE 1674 CORONATION

PURANDAR, AGRA AND THE 1674 CORONATION · THE 1663 POONA NIGHT RAID ON SHAISTA KHAN AND · TWENTY-THREE OF THIRTY-FIVE FORTS WERE TRANSFERRED, TWELVE RETAINED, AND · JAI SINGH'S 1665 SIEGE AND DIPLOMACY PRODUCED THE TREATY

The 1663 Poona night raid on Shaista Khan and the 1664 sack of Surat dented → Jai Singh's 1665 siege and diplomacy produced the Treaty of Purandar: twenty-three of thirty-five forts → The 1666 Agra visit ended in detention over a status and rank crisis, followed by → the popular basket-escape detail is a narrative element with separately flagged provenance, not an administrative → The 1674 Raigad coronation, validated by Gaga Bhatta, converted a regional chief into a recognised

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- The 1663 Poona night raid on Shaista Khan and the 1664 sack of Surat dented Mughal prestige and disrupted commerce without ending the conflict.
- Jai Singh's 1665 siege and diplomacy produced the Treaty of Purandar: twenty-three of thirty-five forts were transferred, twelve

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- The 1666 Agra visit ended in detention over a status and rank crisis, followed by a secure escape
- the popular basket-escape detail is a narrative element with separately flagged provenance, not an administrative record.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- The 1674 Raigad coronation, validated by Gaga Bhatta, converted a regional chief into a recognised sovereign and began
- The legitimacy idiom therefore combined Hindu royal symbolism with Persianate administrative institutions and Muslim officers, which means plural

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The 1663 Poona night raid on Shaista Khan and the 1664 sack of Surat dented Mughal prestige and disrupted commerce without ending the conflict. Jai Singh's 1665 siege and diplomacy produced the Treaty of Purandar: twenty-three of thirty-five forts were transferred, twelve retained, and Sambhaji was granted a Mughal mansab of five thousand, which was an incorporation attempt rather than a final or unconditional surrender. The 1666 Agra visit ended in detention over a status and rank crisis, followed by a secure escape; the popular basket-escape detail is a narrative element with separately flagged provenance, not an administrative record. The 1674 Raigad coronation, validated by Gaga Bhatta, converted a regional chief into a recognised sovereign and began the Rajyabhisheka Shaka era used on later coins and documents. The legitimacy idiom therefore combined Hindu royal symbolism with Persianate administrative institutions and Muslim officers, which means plural legitimacy was the actual formula, not an exclusive Hindu-state claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: twenty-three of thirty-five forts were transferred, twelve retained, and Sambhaji was granted a Mughal mansab of five thousand, which was an incorporation attempt rather than a final or unconditional surrender. The 1666 Agra visit ended in detention over a status and rank crisis, followed by a secure escape; the popular basket-escape detail is a narrative element with separately flagged provenance, not an administrative record. The 1674 Raigad coronation, validated by Gaga Bhatta, converted a regional chief into a recognised sovereign and began the Rajyabhisheka Shaka era used on later coins and documents. The legitimacy idiom therefore combined Hindu royal symbolism with Persianate administrative institutions and Muslim officers, which means plural legitimacy was the actual formula, not an exclusive Hindu-state claim.

STAGE 03

ADMINISTRATION AND REVENUE: ASHTAPRADHAN, CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI

ADMINISTRATION AND REVENUE · ASHTAPRADHAN, CHAUTH AND SARDESHMUKHI · RULER-RESPONSIBLE DUTY · CHIEF MINISTER · RECORDS INTELLIGENCE · FOREIGN AFFAIRS, ARMY, JUSTICE, CHARITY-RITUAL · FORT COMMAND, STORE, RECORD · THE ASHTAPRADHAN'S EIGHT OFFICES WERE EACH INDIVIDUALLY RULER-RESPONSIBLE, NOT

Office	Ruler-responsible duty	Level
Peshwa / Amatya-Mazumdar	Chief minister / revenue-finance	Central
Sachiv / Mantri-Waqia-navis	Correspondence / records intelligence	Central
Sumant-Dabir / Senapati / Nyayadhish / Panditrao	Foreign affairs, army, justice, charity-ritual	Central
Havaldar / Sabnis	Fort command, store, record	Fort-local

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Ruler-responsible duty
- Peshwa / Amatya-Mazumdar
- Chief minister / revenue-finance
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- Correspondence / records intelligence

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Sumant-Dabir / Senapati / Nyayadhish / Panditrao
- Foreign affairs, army, justice, charity-ritual
- Havaldar / Sabnis
- Fort command, store, record
- The Ashtapradhan's eight offices were each individually ruler-responsible, not a collective cabinet answerable to a legislature, and several

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Village and provincial functionaries such as patils, kulkarnis and deshmukhs were retained, so illegal exactions were curbed while
- Annaji Datto's revenue assessment of about 1679 strengthens jama, the assessed demand, but jama is not the same
- Chauth began as a one-fourth protection-linked claim that widened into a political and fiscal claim over time, while
- the rule is that chauth and sardeshmukhi must be kept distinct in rate and rationale, and that collecting

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Ashtapradhan's eight offices were each individually ruler-responsible, not a collective cabinet answerable to a legislature, and several offices combined civil and military duties. Village and provincial functionaries such as patils, kulkarnis and deshmukhs were retained, so illegal exactions were curbed while hereditary local rights were not abolished. Annaji Datto's revenue assessment of about 1679 strengthens jama, the assessed demand, but jama is not the same as hasil, the realised collection, and the gap between them is source-specific rather than a universal rate. Chauth began as a one-fourth protection-linked claim that widened into a political and fiscal claim over time, while sardeshmukhi was a separate ten-per-cent superior-deshmukh claim; the rule is that chauth and sardeshmukhi must be kept distinct in rate and rationale, and that collecting either is not the same as exercising settled sovereignty.

STAGE 04

MILITARY ORGANISATION, NAVAL POWER AND THE FORT NETWORK

MILITARY ORGANISATION, NAVAL POWER AND THE FORT NETWORK · CAVALRY COMBINED BARGIR TROOPERS ON STATE-PROVIDED HORSES WITH SILHEDAR · REMUNERATION WAS MIXED -- CASH PAY, PLUNDER SHARES AND · GANIMI KAVA, THE REPERTOIRE OF SURPRISE, INFORMATION GATHERING, SUPPLY

Cavalry combined bargir troopers on state-provided horses with silhedar troopers who supplied their own mounts → Remuneration was mixed -- cash pay, plunder shares and local mokasa-type assignments together -- not → Ganimi kava, the repertoire of surprise, information gathering, supply disruption and avoidance of unfavourable battle → The navy of gunboats, grabs and gallivats, based at Sindhudurg and Vijaydurg, was a regional → The fort network functioned through storage, observation, signalling and short-radius movement across linked, not isolated

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Cavalry combined bargir troopers on state-provided horses with silhedar troopers who supplied their own mounts, alongside Mavali infantry,
- Remuneration was mixed -- cash pay, plunder shares and local mokasa-type assignments together -- not an all-cash or all-plunder system.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Ganimi kava, the repertoire of surprise, information gathering, supply disruption and avoidance of unfavourable battle, coexisted with siege-holding
- The navy of gunboats, grabs and gallivats, based at Sindhudurg and Vijaydurg, was a regional littoral force for

DEBATE / LEGACY

- The fort network functioned through storage, observation, signalling and short-radius movement across linked, not isolated, nodes.
- Cavalry combined bargir troopers on state-provided horses with silhedar troopers who supplied their own mounts, alongside Mavali infantry,

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cavalry combined bargir troopers on state-provided horses with silhedar troopers who supplied their own mounts, alongside Mavali infantry, fort garrisons and intelligence networks. Remuneration was mixed -- cash pay, plunder shares and local mokasa-type assignments together -- not an all-cash or all-plunder system. Ganimi kava, the repertoire of surprise, information gathering, supply disruption and avoidance of unfavourable battle, coexisted with siege-holding at Panhala and pitched battle at Salher, which means it did not exclude conventional set-piece warfare when conditions favoured it. The navy of gunboats, grabs and gallivats, based at Sindhudurg and Vijaydurg, was a regional littoral force for coastal defence, anti-Sidi operations and trade protection, not a blue-water empire navy, and this scale distinction is the key exam qualification. The fort network functioned through storage, observation, signalling and short-radius movement across linked, not isolated, nodes.

STAGE 05

SUCCESSORS: SAMBHAJI, RAJARAM, GINGEE AND TARABAI

SAMBHAJI, RAJARAM, GINGEE AND TARABAI · SAMBHAJI'S REIGN FROM 1680 TO 1689 WAS CONSTRAINED BY · HIS CAPTURE AT SANGAMESHWAR AND EXECUTION IN 1689 REMOVED · RAJARAM ESCAPED TO GINGEE FOR STRATEGIC DEPTH, AND THE

Sambhaji's reign from 1680 to 1689 was constrained by Prince Akbar's alliance and sustained Mughal

his capture at Sangameshwar and execution in 1689 removed a recognised negotiating head but did → Rajaram escaped to Gingee for strategic depth, and the fort itself fell only in 1698 → Santaji Ghorpade, Dhanaji Jadhav, Ramchandra Pant Amatya and Shankaraji Narayan sustained command, fiscal and administrative

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Sambhaji's reign from 1680 to 1689 was constrained by Prince Akbar's alliance and sustained Mughal pressure
- his capture at Sangameshwar and execution in 1689 removed a recognised negotiating head but did not end resistance,

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Rajaram escaped to Gingee for strategic depth, and the fort itself fell only in 1698, after Rajaram had
- Santaji Ghorpade, Dhanaji Jadhav, Ramchandra Pant Amatya and Shankaraji Narayan sustained command, fiscal and administrative functions through decentralisation,

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Rajaram's death in 1700 brought Tarabai to the regency for her son Shivaji II, continuing decentralised resistance into the new century.
- Sambhaji's reign from 1680 to 1689 was constrained by Prince Akbar's alliance and sustained Mughal pressure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sambhaji's reign from 1680 to 1689 was constrained by Prince Akbar's alliance and sustained Mughal pressure; his capture at Sangameshwar and execution in 1689 removed a recognised negotiating head but did not end resistance, since it shifted resistance toward dispersed commanders, forts and fiscal claims. Rajaram escaped to Gingee for strategic depth, and the fort itself fell only in 1698, after Rajaram had already left -- a fort's fall is therefore not the same as its ruler's capture, and this distinction is a recurring trap qualification. Santaji Ghorpade, Dhanaji Jadhav, Ramchandra Pant Amatya and Shankaraji Narayan sustained command, fiscal and administrative functions through decentralisation, which means resistance survived through distributed command, not one frictionless single organisation. Rajaram's death in 1700 brought Tarabai to the regency for her son Shivaji II, continuing decentralised resistance into the new century.

STAGE 06

AURANGZEB'S DECCAN ANNEXATION AND PROLONGED WAR

AURANGZEB'S DECCAN ANNEXATION AND PROLONGED WAR · BIJAPUR WAS ANNEXED IN 1686 AND GOLCONDA IN 1687 · ANNEXATION ADDED TERRITORY, REVENUE CLAIMS AND NOBLES TO THE · THE VERDICT THAT 'AURANGZEB WON BIJAPUR AND GOLCONDA BUT

Bijapur was annexed in 1686 and Golconda in 1687, removing the buffer states that had

annexation added territory, revenue claims and nobles to the Mughal system but also required new → The verdict that 'Aurangzeb won Bijapur and Golconda but lost the Deccan' is an analytical → it is not a contemporary court verdict, and it does not mean the annexations achieved

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Bijapur was annexed in 1686 and Golconda in 1687, removing the buffer states that had previously mediated Deccan politics
- annexation added territory, revenue claims and nobles to the Mughal system but also required new garrisons, administration and

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- The verdict that 'Aurangzeb won Bijapur and Golconda but lost the Deccan' is an analytical paradox distinguishing map-conquest
- it is not a contemporary court verdict, and it does not mean the annexations achieved nothing.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Between 1700 and 1705 a repetitive siege-recapture dynamic developed around Gingee and other forts, producing operational success with
- This prolonged war is the direct link into the administrative strain that produced the jagirdari crisis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Bijapur was annexed in 1686 and Golconda in 1687, removing the buffer states that had previously mediated Deccan politics; annexation added territory, revenue claims and nobles to the Mughal system but also required new garrisons, administration and long, disturbed lines of communication. The verdict that 'Aurangzeb won Bijapur and Golconda but lost the Deccan' is an analytical paradox distinguishing map-conquest from governable, revenue-realising authority; it is not a contemporary court verdict, and it does not mean the annexations achieved nothing. Between 1700 and 1705 a repetitive siege-recapture dynamic developed around Gingee and other forts, producing operational success with a weak strategic return. This prolonged war is the direct link into the administrative strain that produced the jagirdari crisis.

STAGE 07

THE JAGIRDARI CRISIS MECHANISM

THE JAGIRDARI CRISIS MECHANISM · THE JAGIRDARI CRISIS IS MULTI-CAUSAL, NOT THE PRODUCT OF · WAR DISRUPTION LOWERS REALISED HASIL, WHICH LOWERS JAGIR QUALITY · RANK INFLATION MEANT MUGHAL KHANAZADS, ABSORBED DECCANI NOBLES AND

The jagirdari crisis is multi-causal, not the product of one single cause. → Rank inflation meant Mughal khanazads, absorbed Deccani nobles and soldiers, and Maratha-origin mansabdars all competed → The jama-hasil gap describes assessed revenue exceeding what was actually collected → the illustrative worked figure of jama 100 against hasil 55 is a teaching model, not → Paibaqi land was recorded as unassigned or awaiting assignment, so its paper status did not

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- The jagirdari crisis is multi-causal, not the product of one single cause.
- Rank inflation meant Mughal khanazads, absorbed Deccani nobles and soldiers, and Maratha-origin mansabdars all competed for a limited
- The jama-hasil gap describes assessed revenue exceeding what was actually collected

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- the illustrative worked figure of jama 100 against hasil 55 is a teaching model, not a verified district
- Paibaqi land was recorded as unassigned or awaiting assignment, so its paper status did not equal realised income for any jagirdar.
- Short jagirdar tenure and frequent transfers were meant to prevent entrenchment but instead encouraged quick extraction, bribery and

DEBATE / LEGACY

- The mechanism therefore runs: war disruption lowers realised hasil, which lowers jagir quality, which weakens troop maintenance, which

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The jagirdari crisis is multi-causal, not the product of one single cause. Rank inflation meant Mughal khanazads, absorbed Deccani nobles and soldiers, and Maratha-origin mansabdars all competed for a limited pool of productive jagirs, producing be-jagiri, a shortage of assignable productive land against rising claimant pressure. The jama-hasil gap describes assessed revenue exceeding what was actually collected; the illustrative worked figure of jama 100 against hasil 55 is a teaching model, not a verified district statistic, and must always be qualified as such. Paibaqi land was recorded as unassigned or awaiting assignment, so its paper status did not equal realised income for any jagirdar. Short jagirdar tenure and frequent transfers were meant to prevent entrenchment but instead encouraged quick extraction, bribery and factional competition, which weakened troop maintenance. The mechanism therefore runs: war disruption lowers realised hasil, which lowers jagir quality, which weakens troop maintenance, which forces more campaigning, and the loop repeats.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: war disruption lowers realised hasil, which lowers jagir quality, which weakens troop maintenance, which forces more campaigning, and the loop repeats.

STAGE 08

LOCAL POWER AND THE MULTI-CAUSAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

LOCAL POWER AND THE MULTI-CAUSAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN · ZAMINDARS, DESHMUKHS AND LOCAL ARMED GROUPS WERE NEITHER PURE · LONG COMMUNICATIONS RAISE LOGISTICS COSTS, CAMPAIGNING DISTURBS HASIL COLLECTION · THE CONSEQUENCE CHAIN RUNS AS A CLOSED LOOP, NOT

Zamindars, deshmukhs and local armed groups were neither pure Mughal officials nor simple landlords → The consequence chain runs as a closed loop, not a single 1707 event: long communications → This crisis matured during the Deccan war and interacts with the Rajput rupture and religious-policy

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Zamindars, deshmukhs and local armed groups were neither pure Mughal officials nor simple landlords -- they bargained, resisted,
- The consequence chain runs as a closed loop, not a single 1707 event: long communications raise logistics costs,

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- This crisis matured during the Deccan war and interacts with the Rajput rupture and religious-policy legitimacy issues covered
- Zamindars, deshmukhs and local armed groups were neither pure Mughal officials nor simple landlords -- they bargained, resisted,

DEBATE / LEGACY

- The consequence chain runs as a closed loop, not a single 1707 event: long communications raise logistics costs,
- This crisis matured during the Deccan war and interacts with the Rajput rupture and religious-policy legitimacy issues covered

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Zamindars, deshmukhs and local armed groups were neither pure Mughal officials nor simple landlords -- they bargained, resisted, or struck private pacts amid parallel Mughal jama-hasil gaps and Maratha chauth claims operating in the very same district, which made sovereignty negotiable in practice rather than absolute on paper. The consequence chain runs as a closed loop, not a single 1707 event: long communications raise logistics costs, campaigning disturbs hasil collection, poorer jagir quality weakens troop maintenance, troop shortfalls make campaigning harder, and repeated campaigns intensify the original disturbance. This crisis matured during the Deccan war and interacts with the Rajput rupture and religious-policy legitimacy issues covered elsewhere in the syllabus, and it feeds directly into the post-1707 confederate transition analysed separately -- a boundary statement, not scope creep into another topic.

STAGE 09

SOURCES, PYQ STATUS, ANSWER SPINE, TRAPS AND BOUNDED HERITAGE

SOURCES, PYQ STATUS, ANSWER SPINE, TRAPS AND BOUNDED HERITAGE · SABHASAD BAKHAR PRESERVES COURTLY MARATHA MEMORY, MUGHAL PERSIAN CHRONICLES · FRAME GEOGRAPHY AS ENABLING RATHER THAN DETERMINING, SHOW STATE · EVERY HISTORIOGRAPHICAL FRAME -- NATIONALIST, COMMUNAL, MARXIST-PEASANT, OR REGIONAL-STATE

Sabhasad Bakhar preserves courtly Maratha memory, Mughal Persian chronicles preserve imperial perception (their 'rebel/bandit' vocabulary → every historiographical frame -- nationalist, communal, Marxist-peasant, or regional-state -- must be tied to this → No verified direct Topic-23 Prelims PYQ exists for 2018-2026 → the 2018, 2019, 2022 and 2024 items route to other topics on subject-matter grounds, and → The answer spine therefore means: frame geography as enabling rather than determining, show state formation

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- Sabhasad Bakhar preserves courtly Maratha memory, Mughal Persian chronicles preserve imperial perception (their 'rebel/bandit' vocabulary is a state
- every historiographical frame -- nationalist, communal, Marxist-peasant, or regional-state -- must be tied to this evidence rather than
- No verified direct Topic-23 Prelims PYQ exists for 2018-2026

METHOD / DEBATE

- the 2018, 2019, 2022 and 2024 items route to other topics on subject-matter grounds, and marks are not
- The answer spine therefore means: frame geography as enabling rather than determining, show state formation through forts, revenue
- Recurring traps include geography-determinism, treating Purandar or the coronation as final, collapsing chauth and sardeshmukhi into one claim,

HISTORICAL RESULT

- UNESCO's 2025 'Maratha Military Landscapes' listing of twelve component forts is a dated, bounded heritage bridge into the

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Sabhasad Bakhar preserves courtly Maratha memory, Mughal Persian chronicles preserve imperial perception (their 'rebel/bandit' vocabulary is a state perspective, not a neutral description), European factory records preserve commercial disruption and rumour rather than Maratha ledgers, and forts, coins and inscriptions preserve capacity, legitimacy and spatial organisation; every historiographical frame -- nationalist, communal, Marxist-peasant, or regional-state -- must be tied to this evidence rather than asserted as automatically complete. No verified direct Topic-23 Prelims PYQ exists for 2018-2026; the 2018, 2019, 2022 and 2024 items route to other topics on subject-matter grounds, and marks are not item-stated in the official record, so a fixed mark value must never be asserted. The answer spine therefore means: frame geography as enabling rather than determining, show state formation through forts, revenue and legitimacy rather than romantic myth, present plural legitimacy alongside a real administrative structure, treat the jagirdari crisis as multi-causal, and qualify every contested detail using the fact-risk ledger. Recurring traps include geography-determinism, treating Purandar or the coronation as final, collapsing chauth and sardeshmukhi into one claim, inflating the navy to blue-water scale, and conflating a fort's fall with its ruler's capture. UNESCO's 2025 'Maratha Military Landscapes' listing of twelve component forts is a dated, bounded heritage bridge into the argument, not primary evidence for any specific seventeenth-century battle or force size.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: frame geography as enabling rather than determining, show state formation through forts, revenue and legitimacy rather than romantic myth, present plural legitimacy alongside a real administrative structure, treat the jagirdari crisis as multi-causal, and qualify every contested detail using the fact-risk ledger. Recurring traps include geography-determinism, treating Purandar or the coronation as final, collapsing chauth and sardeshmukhi into one claim, inflating the navy to blue-water scale, and conflating a fort's fall with its ruler's capture. UNESCO's 2025 'Maratha Military Landscapes' listing of twelve component forts is a dated, bounded heritage bridge into the argument, not primary evidence for any specific seventeenth-century battle or force size.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · OPTIONAL DEPTH ONLY; 12 SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS. · NOTHING HERE IS REQUIRED FOR A CORE BASIC ANSWER. · LAB 1 — JAI SINGH VS AURANGZEB ON SHIVAJI. · SOURCE POINT · JAI SINGH TREATED SHIVAJI AS A POTENTIAL ALLY TO · AURANGZEB TREATED HIM AS A MINOR BHUMIA AND REFUSED · WHICH READING BETTER EXPLAINS THE POST-AGRA BREAKDOWN, AND WHAT

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Optional depth only; 12 source-to-argument labs.
- Nothing here is required for a core Basic answer.
- Lab 1 — Jai Singh vs Aurangzeb on Shivaji.
- Source point: Jai Singh treated Shivaji as a potential ally to fold into a forward Deccan policy

ADVANCED DEBATE

- Aurangzeb treated him as a minor bhumia and refused durable concessions.
- Task: Which reading better explains the post-Agra breakdown, and what does the divergence cost the Mughal side?
- Lab 2 — Be-jagiri as a distinct mechanism.
- Source point: Be-jagiri names a shortage of assignable productive jagirs, separate from the jama-hasil gap on jagirs already assigned.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Task: Show how the two mechanisms could operate on the same mansabdar at once without being the same problem.
- Lab 3 — Chauth's documentary evolution.
- Source point: Chauth moved from a protection-linked claim toward an
- organised levy collected through local agents (kamaish-dars) in contested districts.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.